

MANN REPORT

MANAGEMENT



YOUR KEY TO SECURITY

WEBSTER LOCKSMITHS

David Miller and Allan Miller

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Webster Locksmiths

In the Dispatch Office at Webster Locksmiths, a large electronic wall map depicts the New York metropolitan area. On it, dots of light indicate the up-to-the-minute locations of Webster's service vans – some 35 of them, in constant radio contact with the office, carrying the company's more than 50 technicians throughout the area. Webster is the largest locksmith in the five boroughs of New York, and, through three generations, has built a reputation for industry-leading capability and service.

"Service" is the operative word at Webster. Within a single day, the company's uniformed technicians can be found working throughout the region, fulfilling a broad variety of jobs. They could be installing iron gates for a building's entrances; measuring a building for installation of Webster's own company-designed decorative railings; assembling and installing custom-made window gates to meet Fire Department regulations; creating master keys for an apartment complex; installing or repairing a building's intercom system and mailboxes, or literally riding to the rescue to help a car owner who's lost his ignition key.

These are just a few of Webster's myriad services that ensure the safety and security of hundreds of apartment complexes, commercial properties and homes throughout New York City and Westchester County. The city's largest real estate owners and managers rely on Webster Locksmiths – for example, Glenwood Management, Halstead Properties, Langsam Properties, Pinnacle Management and Related – as do retailers such as Hermes, Vera Wang, Applebees, McDonald's and Fairway. Famed institutions such as the United Nations and Yankee Stadium are also long-time Webster clients.

Webster Locksmith's tradition of service stretches back more than six decades. In 1949, a young couple, Mike and Ann Miller, founded a neighborhood store that sold housewares and hardware. It was named for its location: Webster Avenue, in the Bronx. Often, in those days, sons joined their family's business, but Mike and Ann's son, Allan, thought differently. "To me," Allan recalls today, "it was a pots-and-pans store. I didn't want to go into it that way." He began his working life elsewhere. However, two years later, he and his parents were discussing the business's future and its potential, and Allan began to see that his participation could be helpful to Mike and Ann. He joined the business in 1964, and began making changes. He brought in the store's first key machine and offered locksmith services. He created a Service Department, and bought its first service truck. He introduced welding equipment. The enterprise became Webster Lock and Hardware, then simply Webster Locksmiths. Today, Allan Miller is the company's Chief Executive Officer.

The business has continued to grow and change – in large measure, says Allan, through the work of the company's Vice President for Operations, Allan's son, David, who now represents the founding family's third generation. Today, Webster Locksmith has become the largest security provider of products and services for the real estate management community in New York City. Its modern 16,000-square-foot headquarters is just down the road from the original store, and houses the company's administrative offices, operations and dispatch center, locksmith center, garage, and stockroom/

storehouse for a growing range of products designed for today's co-operatives, condominiums, other apartment complexes, homes and offices. The headquarters, which retains a busy, fully-stocked retail hardware and security super-store on the ground floor, was designed and constructed under David's supervision.

David needed no persuasion to join the company: he took to it as a youngster, and joined soon after his graduation from Ithaca College. In partnership with his father, David has built the company to where today it offers the broadest range of security products and systems:

- For property protection: Webster has its architectural iron made to order by professional steel fabricators, ensuring high quality with short lead time and competitive pricing.
- Railings, made of decorative steel, can be custom-made in varying heights and lengths, in special colors and with other modifications.
- Webster provides FDNY-approved fire escape gates, designed to deter burglars, as well as window guards to protect children.

Webster also offers products that ensure security within a building, apartment or office. These include high quality/low cost iron doors, hollow metal doors, wood doors, aluminum doors and apartment doors. In addition, Webster installs intercoms that provide two-way speech communication; systems that allow for door lock and release; heavy-duty, all-metal CCTV surveillance cameras that can connect directly to a resident's television set, and more. The security of tenants' mail is also ensured with Webster's storehouse of mailboxes, available in a variety of finishes. Everything is custom-installed.

Webster's origins as locksmiths continue to provide every-day value to its clients. The company offers same-day installation of locks by factory-trained technicians, as well as emergency duplication of a client's keys. These include keys produced on Webster's own proprietary blanks, so they can't be replicated except by Webster's own craftsmen.

"Webster is the only company that we use for all our properties," says Billy Schur, Vice President, Schur Management Company. "In addition to general locksmith work, we use them for installing building entrance doors and apartment doors. We use their Iron Division for gates and their Intercom Division for intercom service and repair. We find them to be reputable and honest, a company with the utmost integrity when dealing with their customers."

Webster Lock began as part of the New York business community, and it continues in that tradition. David Miller, for example, takes time to serve as a member of the Community Housing Improvement Program (CHIP), and of the Board of Governors of the Bronx Manhattan Association of Realtors. He is a member of the Executive Association of New York City (EANYC), one of the nation's largest networking groups, and is an active member of his industry group, Associated Locksmiths of America.

He is busy, too, outside the realm of business. He is Event Chair-

Allan Miller and David Miller



man, Men's Division, for the Einstein College of Medicine, helping to raise money for medical research, and he is active in fundraising for Community Mainstreaming Associates (CMA), which provides housing and job training for individuals with developmental disabilities. For his work with CMA, the organization is honoring David in the summer of 2013 as its Man of the Year.

"David is one of the most hardworking and well-connected people in New York real estate," says James Eisenberg, a principal at Urban American. "He is very generous with his time and attention—not only with his customers, but with organizations, people and the community he serves. We are proud to be a loyal customer for over ten years. We can always depend on Webster's quality and excellent service." Says another client, Matthew Engel, Vice President at Langsam Properties, which manages some 300 apartment buildings: "Webster probably does five jobs a day for our company. Webster is our main locksmith. They're also the people we go to for decorative steel work, non-structural stairs, front doors and inter-

com systems. David Miller is a very hands-on owner, very active and very involved. If there's an issue or a problem with a superintendent, he calls me directly. They do a great job."

Through three generations, Webster has continued to grow and evolve with the times, embracing and leading with new technologies and capabilities to service its clients' changing needs. Today the company's strength remains its ability to provide the highest quality, consistent and responsive service to the most demanding clients in the industry.

By Peter Haas

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The Webster Difference

New York's Largest Security Service Company

Family owned and operated for over 60 years, we have a proven formula of success. With over 30 service vehicles we offer our clients same day service within the 5 boroughs of New York City and Westchester County.

Our factory trained uniformed service technicians are experts in everything from simple lock changes to complex glass and steel door repairs and replacements.



DOORS & FRAMES



IRON WORKS



INTERCOM/CCTV

World-Class Service

- Locksmith Services
- Doors and Frames
- Intercom Services/CCTV
- Magnetic Lock Violations
- Automotive Transponder Keys
- Custom Iron Fabrication
- Decorative Hardware Showroom

Certified Expertise

- Medeco M3
- Mul-T-Lock MT5
- Detex
- LCN
- Adams Rite
- Marks U.S.A
- Schlage
- Von Duprin
- Lee Dan
- Folger Adams
- Rixson
- Securittech

Trusted by Many

The leading choice among top facility and property managers in the five boroughs and Westchester:

Glenwood Management • Langsam Properties • Pinnacle Management • Philips International • United Nations • Tryax Realty • Halstead Properties • Applebees • Auto Zones

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